

ARUN AND FRIENDS

(Proposed partnership enterprise — Tender-Coconut & Agri-Biomass Biochar Unit)
4/296, Mangapallam South, RVP Pudur Post, Palakkad District, Kerala – 678555
Phone: 9901955667 · Email: er.arunt@gmail.com

Ref: AAF/KSPCB/CAT/2026/[]

Date: [] July 2026

To: The Member Secretary,
Kerala State Pollution Control Board,
Pattom, Thiruvananthapuram – 695004.

Copy to: The Environmental Engineer, KSPCB District Office, Palakkad.

Subject: Request for written clarification on the applicable pollution-control category (Orange vs. Green) for a proposed continuous, low-emission **agri-biomass biochar (soil-amendment) unit** at Eruthenpathy, Chittur, Palakkad, under the KSPCB revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025 — prior to filing the Consent to Establish.

Reference:

- KSPCB Notification No. KSPCB/159/2022-SEE-3 dated 10.08.2024 (Categorization Committee, 29.05.2024) — “Charcoal Production from Coconut Shell by Pyrolysis — Orange.”
- KSPCB Revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025.
- KSPCB “Environmental Guidelines for Charcoal Manufacturing Units” dated 02.12.2025.
- KSPCB circular dated 16.09.2025 on self-certification-based CTE/CTO.
- CPCB Directions dated 07.03.2016 (u/s 18(1)(b) of the Water Act 1974 & Air Act 1981) and 12.02.2025 — Pollution-Index categorisation methodology.

Respected Sir/Madam,

We, **Arun and Friends** (a proposed partnership enterprise), intend to establish a **continuous, low-emission biochar unit** on an owned 38-cent plot at Eruthenpathy, Chittur Taluk (Block No. 30, Survey No. 300), Palakkad. Before filing our Consent to Establish, we respectfully seek a **written clarification on the sector entry and pollution-category applicable to our unit** under the revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025.

2. Nature of the proposed unit

- **Product:** biochar as a soil amendment / feedstock for enriched (microbe-inoculated) organic bio-fertilizer — **not** fuel charcoal, **not** activated carbon, and with **no** pyrolysis-oil or carbon-black recovery.
- **Feedstock:** mixed agri-biomass — tender-coconut husk briquettes, coconut fronds/petioles, shells and coir pith, and seasonal agri-residue. It is not a coconut-shell-only charcoal operation.
- **Capacity:** Phase-1 $\approx$ 1 t/day biochar (consent applied rated for the 2 t/day ultimate).
- **Process & controls:** closed, continuous/semi-continuous pyrolysis with a syngas afterburner/flare (self-fuelling), cyclone/dust collector, alkaline scrubber with mist eliminator and a stack meeting KSPCB norms; continuous temperature monitoring and emergency shutdown; **Zero-Liquid-Discharge** (tar condensate and scrubber blowdown captured and managed). No open burning at any stage.

3. The classification question

Our unit could be read against either of two entries. We request confirmation of which one applies:

Candidate sector entry	Category	Consent regime
“Charcoal production from coconut shell by pyrolysis” (Notification dated 10.08.2024)	ORANGE	Consent to Establish + Consent to Operate; periodic monitoring
General charcoal / char (biochar) production — as we	GREEN	Simplified consent regime

Candidate sector entry	Category	Consent regime
understand it is classified under the revised list as on 29.12.2025		

4. Why we submit the general (lighter) entry is the correct fit

- **Not “coconut shell.”** Our feedstock is mixed agri-biomass, not a coconut-shell-only charge; the 10.08.2024 Orange entry is worded specifically for “coconut shell.”
- **Not “charcoal” for fuel, nor activated carbon.** The product is biochar for soil; there is no oil/carbon-black recovery and no chemical/steam activation — the features that drive the heavier categories.
- **Low pollution potential on the CPCB Pollution-Index basis.** A closed, continuous process with afterburner, scrubber, controlled stack emissions and Zero-Liquid-Discharge has a materially lower Pollution Index than the coconut-shell charcoal / activated-carbon activities.
- **Guideline-compliant by design.** The unit is designed to meet the “Environmental Guidelines for Charcoal Manufacturing Units” dated 02.12.2025 (emission control, stack, ash/dust housekeeping, heat reutilisation, responsible feedstock sourcing).

5. Clarifications requested

We respectfully request the Board to clarify, in writing:

1. **The applicable entry and category.** Whether the described agri-biomass biochar (soil-amendment) unit falls under the general charcoal/char (biochar) production entry (Green) in the revised list as on 29.12.2025, rather than the “charcoal production from coconut shell by pyrolysis” (Orange) entry of 10.08.2024.
2. **If Orange is held to apply,** the consent conditions, and whether the unit is eligible for the self-certification route under the 16.09.2025 circular at our capital-investment level.
3. **The applicable technical norms** (emission limits, minimum stack height, distance/siting criteria) under the 02.12.2025 charcoal guidelines that we must design to.
4. **Confirmation that no public hearing or Environmental Clearance** is required for the unit (being outside the Red / EIA-2006 scheduled category).

6. Enclosures

- Brief project note / DPR extract (concept, capacity, mass balance).
- Process-flow and emission-control schematic (afterburner → cyclone → scrubber → stack; ZLD line).
- Feedstock list and plot details (survey no., extent, land-use, setbacks).

An early written clarification will let us file a correctly-categorised Consent to Establish and design the unit to the exact norms. We shall be glad to furnish any further particulars or meet the concerned officer at the District Office.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

Arun T. — for and on behalf of Arun and Friends (proposed)
Phone: 9901955667 · Email: er.arunt@gmail.com